Title: The Sound of First Intuition

Interface and Key Mapping: Using the Freedsound Loop Generator, the 16 triggers are divided into two zones:

- **Left Zone (Odd):** Keys 3, 4, W, E, S, D, Z, X
- **Right Zone (Even):** Keys 5, 6, R, T, F, G, C, V

The Algorithmic Rules:

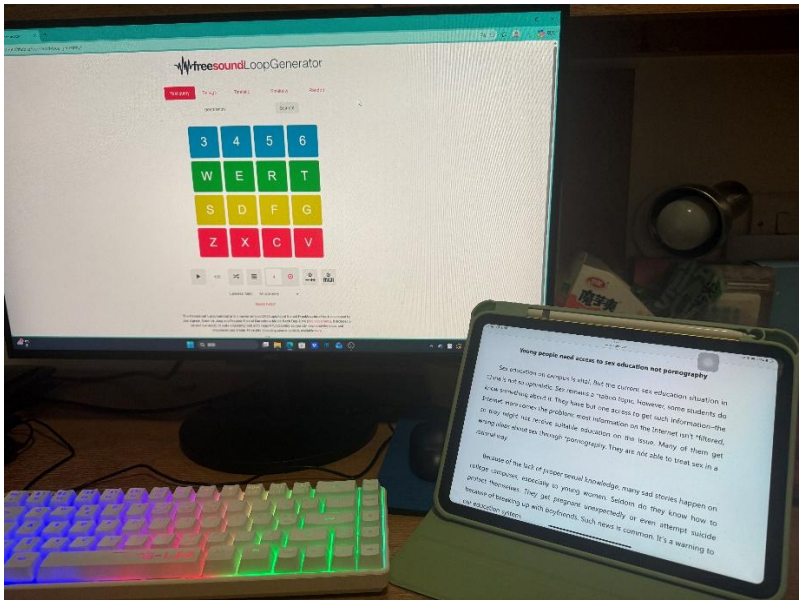
1. **The Intuition Trigger:** Randomly open an article (physical or digital). Look at the text and capture the *very first word* that catches my eye based on pure intuition.
2. **The Algorithm:** Count the number of letters in that word.

   If ODD: Press one random key in the Left Zone.

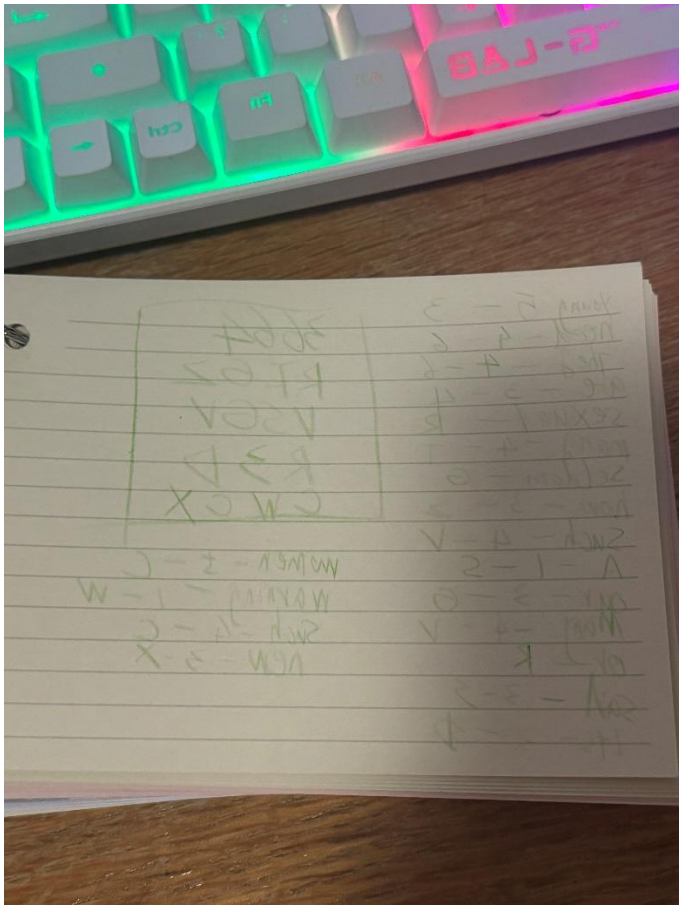
   If EVEN: Press one random key in the Right Zone.
3. **The Recording Phase:** Write down (or memorize) the exact key I just pressed. Wait for the sound to fade, then repeat steps 1 and 2 to collect a sequence of 10 to 15 sounds. This creates a slow, sparse soundscape.
4. **The Final Synthesis:** Once the sequence is collected, I will rapidly play back the entire sequence of keys I just recorded, one after another without pausing. This transforms the isolated "intuitions" into a synthesized, structured musical finale.

Pictures:

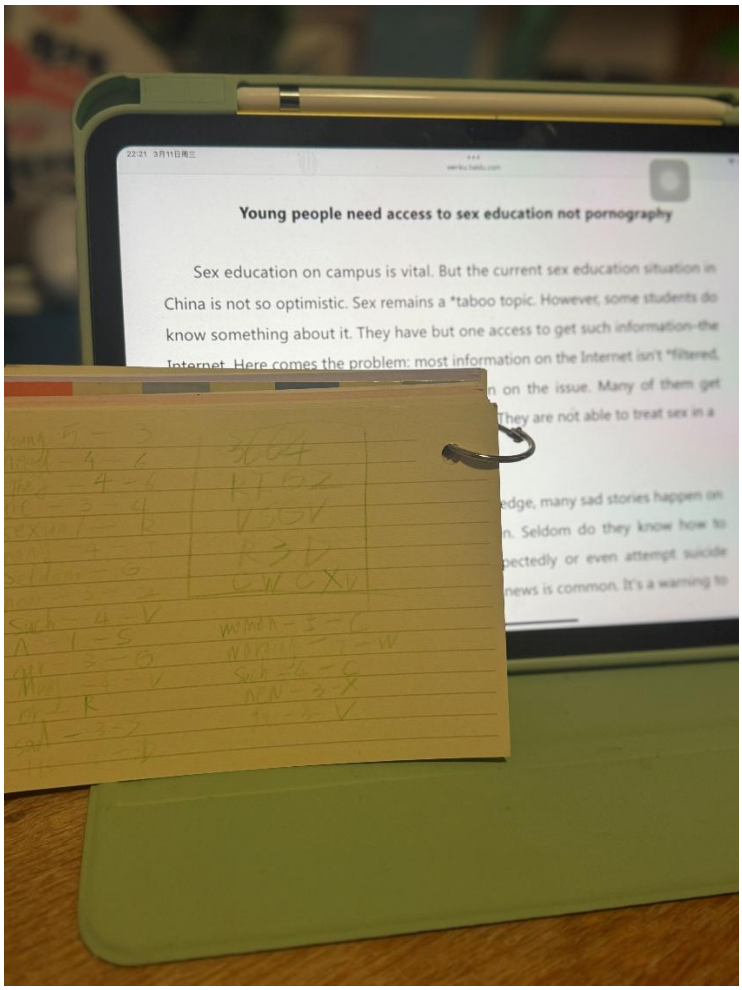
Prepare an article and open the music software.



Record the words you see at first sight and check whether they are odd or even.



Organise the last letters to be played.



Reflection

I named my interactive soundscape project "The Sound of First Intuition." To explain my motivation, I have to mention a cherished memory with my grandma. When I was a kid in the countryside, we played a simple game with small stones. She would throw a stone on the ground; if it bounced an odd number of times, she clapped once. If it bounced an even number of times, she clapped twice. This simple rule created a unique, unpredictable rhythm. This memory became the core inspiration for my algorithmic performance.

While designing the rules, I was heavily inspired by the "Fluxus" art movement and Japanese experimental artists like Yoko Ono and Takehisa Kosugi. They often used daily actions or simple text instructions as an "Event Score" to create art rather than traditional musical notes. My rule counting the letters of a randomly chosen word to trigger left or right sounds,is directly inspired by their philosophy. At the same time, my performance is also a simple form of "Text Sonification," where I translate physical text data into an audio experience.

For the tool, I chose the Freesound Loop Generator. I selected it because it can quickly load 16 completely random and unpredictable sound samples, ranging from natural environments to mechanical noises. This unpredictability perfectly matches my chance-based design.

However, there was a significant limitation that deeply inspired me. This software is originally designed as a step sequencer to generate music loops. To strictly follow the assignment rule of not using autonomous generation, I had to overcome this limitation. I decided to completely ignore its main looping feature and use my computer keyboard to manually trigger the 16 pads. This limitation inspired me to transform an automatic sequencing tool into a live, manual performance instrument.

My performance strictly follows an algorithm. I open an English Article and pick the first word my intuition sees. I count the letters: if it is an odd number, I press a key on the left side of my keyboard; if even, I press the right side. The performance has two phases. First, I do this slowly, creating a scattered soundscape while secretly writing down my keystrokes. Then, for the climax, I rapidly play back the entire recorded sequence.

Ultimately, my algorithmic rules sometimes produce chaotic and unharmoniously audio textures. However, I believe this "ugliness" is exactly the core beauty of chance operations. It removes my subjective musical bias and lets the algorithm decide. It reminds us that sound is just sound, and we don't always need to force it into a traditional musical structure.